

Final Presentation

ASE285 ChatGPT Clone

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Project Overview

- Full-stack ChatGPT-style application
- Real-time messaging with AI responses
- User authentication and private sessions
- File upload with AI processing
- Docker-based build and run setup

Core Requirements

- Users can sign up, log in, and have private chat sessions
- Users can start, manage, and switch between chats
- Users can send messages and receive real-time AI responses
- Conversation history persists across sessions
- Users can upload files shown as clean previews
- App is runnable using Docker outside localhost setup

Technology Stack

- Frontend: React
- Backend: Node.js + Express
- Real-time: Socket.IO
- Database: MongoDB
- Authentication: JWT + bcrypt
- AI: OpenAI API
- Deployment: Docker + Docker Compose

System Architecture

```
React Frontend
  |
REST API + Socket.IO
  |
Node / Express Backend
  |
MongoDB + OpenAI API
```

- Frontend handles the user interface
- Backend handles auth, sockets, file processing, and AI requests
- MongoDB stores user-specific sessions

Sprint 1 Progress

- Week 5: UI functionality and improvement
- Week 6: WebSocket connection and session management
- Week 7: End-to-end messaging
- Week 8: OpenAI integration

Sprint 2 Progress

- **Week 10:** Backend persistence for conversations
- **Week 11:** Search, filter, and sort conversations
- **Week 12:** AI thinking indicator
- **Week 13:** Authentication
- **Week 14:** File attachment
- **Week 15:** Tests and deployment

Metrics

- Total LoC: ~3500
- Features Planned: 11
- Features Completed: 11
- Test Coverage: Unit, Integration, Regression, Acceptance

Testing Summary

- **Unit Tests:** Component-level tests
- **Integration Tests:** Dashboard, socket events, and chat workflows
- **Regression Tests:** Previously fixed bugs
- **Acceptance Tests:** Full user flows

Tests cover authentication, chat sessions, messaging, file uploads, search/filter/sort, and regression checks.

What Went Wrong

- CORS issues during frontend/backend connection
- Socket.IO had a learning curve
- OpenAI API setup caused delays
- Learning Curve with Docker
- Debugging Docker and MongoDB configuration took time

What Went Well

- Real-time chat was successfully implemented
- AI integration was completed
- User-specific sessions now work correctly
- File upload works with clean previews
- Docker setup makes the app easier to run

Key Problems Solved

- Fixed chats showing across different users
- Added JWT-based socket authentication
- Stored conversations by user ID
- Prevented raw file content from displaying in the UI
- Kept file content available for AI processing

Deployment

The app can be built and run using Docker Compose:

```
docker compose up --build
```

Then open:

```
http://localhost:3000
```

Future Improvements

- Streaming AI responses
- Drag-and-drop file upload
- Better file preview cards
- Dark/light mode toggle
- Hosted production deployment

Final Outcome

- Multi-user ChatGPT-style application
- Real-time AI messaging
- Persistent private chat history
- File attachment support
- Search, filter, sort, rename, delete, and pin chats
- Tested and Docker-ready

Thank You